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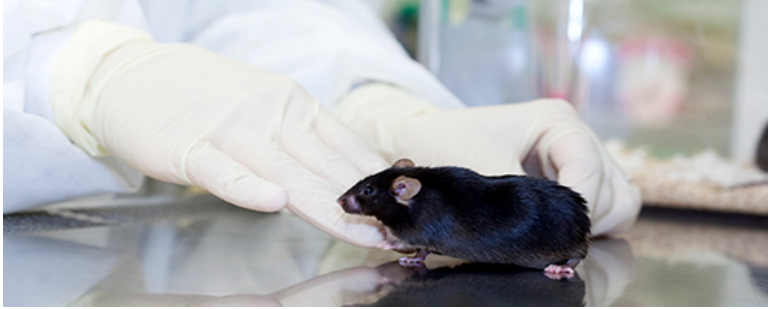
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Office of Research & Development

VA Animal Research Program



Animal research has saved the lives of millions of Veterans, and will continue to do so.

[Overview](#) of Animal Research in VA

To conduct the research needed to improve medical care, we sometimes have to work with animal models. Studying animals is still the only scientifically viable way to get some of the knowledge we need to improve human health, and indeed the health of other animals that benefit from veterinary care. VA allows research with animals only if it is scientifically necessary and if animal-welfare safeguards are adhered to.

The VA PTSD/Service Dog Study

As authorized by Congress, VA completed a study to determine if service dogs can help Veterans with PTSD. [Read about this study.](#)

ABOUT ANIMAL RESEARCH IN VA

- [Animal Research Overview](#)
- [Animal Research FAQ](#)
- [Canine Research](#)
- [Animal Research Fact Sheet](#)
- [Research Day Poster](#)

MORE ABOUT ANIMAL RESEARCH

- [Americans for Medical Progress](#)
- [Foundation for Biomedical Research](#)
- [National Association for Biomedical Research](#)
- [FASEB Briefing](#)
- [Speaking Up for the Value of Animal Research](#)
- [Speaking of Research](#)

Resources for Administrators and Researchers

RESEARCH GUIDANCE

- [Annual Continuing Review of Protocols](#)
- [Technical Summaries](#)
- [Criteria for NSM and NAM](#)
- [Drafting an MOU](#)

[More Guidance](#)

RELATED DOCUMENTS

- [Use of Animals in Research](#)
- [Forms for Semiannual Evaluations of the Institutional Care](#)
- [Contracting Documents](#)
- [Animal Component of Research](#)

[More Documents](#)

News About Animal Research

VA Research Currents and VA news releases

[Lab studies seek hormone-based obesity treatment](#) (Jan. 18, 2022)

[Brain trauma: Combined treatment improves cell connectivity in important memory center of the brain.](#) (Oct. 30, 2020)

[Does smoking block potential benefits from stem cell therapy?](#) (Sept. 1, 2020)

[Lab study suggests way to stem long-term damage after brain injury](#) (June 11, 2020)

[Lab study: E-cigarettes may damage body's ability to fight infection](#) (Jan. 15, 2020)

[Comprehending the effects of blasts](#) (June 27, 2019)

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VA Research news briefs

[E-cigarettes may weaken muscle strength and healing](#) (Nov. 3, 2022)

[Bacteria transplantation could treat alcohol use disorder](#) (Oct. 27, 2022)

[Potential new treatment for cocaine use disorder](#) (Dec. 27, 2021)

[Daily fasting could improve metabolic health, suggests mouse study](#) (Nov. 17, 2021)

[Gulf War toxic exposure may be linked to damaging gene expression changes](#) (Aug. 4, 2021)

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Any health information on this website is strictly for informational purposes and is not intended as medical advice. It should not be used to diagnose or treat any condition.

Veteran programs and services

Homeless Veterans
Women Veterans
Minority Veterans
LGBTQ+ Veterans
PTSD
Mental health
Adaptive sports and special events
VA outreach events
National Resource Directory

More VA resources

VA forms
VA health care access and quality
Accredited claims representatives
VA mobile apps
State Veterans Affairs offices
Doing business with VA
Careers at VA
VA outreach materials
Your VA welcome kit

Get VA updates

VA news
Press releases
Email updates
Facebook
Instagram
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YouTube
All VA social media

In crisis? Get help now

Veterans Crisis Line

Get answers

Resources and support
Contact us

Call us

800-698-2411
TTY: 711

Visit a medical center or regional office

Find a VA location

Language assistance

